Siyoung Lee
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EDUCATION

Sogang University, Republic of Korea — Sep 2025–Present
M.A. in Economics (in progress, GPA: 4.30/4.30)

Sogang University, Republic of Korea — Aug 2025
B.A. in Economics (GPA: 4.27/4.30)
B.S. in Mathematics (GPA: 4.05/4.30)

- Ranked 1st in the School of Economics (out of 63 graduates)
- Graduated early, completing both degrees in seven semesters
- Honors in Economic Theory

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Macroeconomics, International Finance, Spatial Economics, Econometrics

WORKING PAPERS

"Correlated Country Risk and International Capital Allocation"
(with Jun Hee Kwak) [Link]

- *Role:* Originated the research question and carried out the project from data construction and model development through estimation and quantitative simulations.
- *Abstract:* Documents that bilateral interest-rate differentials increase systematically with geographic distance. Develops and estimates a multi-country general equilibrium model in which geography shapes international capital allocation through bilateral portfolio frictions and spatially correlated destination attractiveness. Quantitative analyses show that these geographic channels play an important role in explaining cross country interest rate dispersion and the long-run distribution of capital and output.

"Sensitivity Analysis in Sharp Regression Discontinuity Designs"
(with Sungwon Lee, Sukyung Joo, and Beomsu Kim) [Link]

- *Abstract:* Develops a partial identification framework for extrapolating causal effects beyond the cutoff in sharp regression discontinuity designs. Derives sharp bounds on average and distributional treatment effects under smoothness restrictions on potential outcome distributions, parameterized by interpretable sensitivity measures. Demonstrates the method through Monte Carlo simulations and an empirical application on external validity.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Research Center for Big Data on Korean Economy — May 2025–Present

Project: *"The Geography of Fertility: Theory and Evidence from Korea"*

Co-PIs: **Costas Arkolakis (Yale), Jun Hee Kwak (Sogang), Hyunjoo Yang (Sogang)**

- Designed and implemented the project's structural estimation strategy, including analytical derivations for parameter identification and estimation.
- Designed and implemented reduced-form empirical analyses, including empirical specifications, variable construction, estimation, and robustness exercises across multiple levels of geographic aggregation.
- Built and integrated administrative and geographic datasets with population-scale financial, mobility, and consumption microdata, and developed procedures to process and validate proprietary data against administrative records.

Research Assistant for **Prof. Jun Hee Kwak (Sogang)** — Mar 2025–July 2025

- Constructed a sanctions measure for the project and conducted regression analyses.

WORK IN PROGRESS

"A Spatial Theory of Exchange Rate Disconnect"

- Develops an open economy model of exchange rates to study how geographic frictions shape the cross-country transmission of financial shocks.

PRESENTATIONS

- The International Symposium on Econometric Theory and Applications, Tokyo, Japan — June 2026
- KER International Conference, Jeju, Republic of Korea — June 2026

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant for Prof. Younghoon Lee — Sep 2025 – Present

- Econometrics, Economic Statistics

Tutor, Economics Study Center, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025 – Present

- Econometrics, Advanced Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Economic Statistics

SCHOLARSHIPS / FELLOWSHIPS

Albatross Fellowship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025– Present

Brain Korea 21-Four Fellowship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025– Present

TA Scholarship, Sogang Univ — Sep 2025– Present

Dean's List Award $\times 3$, Sogang Univ — Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2023

Academic Excellence Award (Top 1% of students), Sogang Univ — Fall 2021

Integrated Undergrad-Grad Degree Program Scholarship, Sogang Univ. — Sep 2025

SELECTED COURSEWORK

Economics
Macroeconomics (G), Advanced Topics in Macroeconomics (G), International Finance (G), Microeconomics (G), Econometrics (G), Microeconometrics (G), Dynamic Programming

Mathematics & Statistics
Real Analysis (G), Advanced Mathematical Statistics (G), Advanced Linear Algebra (G), Topology I–II, Advanced Calculus I–II, Mathematical Statistics, Probability Theory

(G) denotes graduate-level coursework.

SKILLS

Programming & Software: Python, Stata, Julia, MATLAB, LaTeX

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)